INTRODUCTION WRITING FOR A RESEARCH PAPER

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DIKIOHS

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this presentation, you will be able to:

- Understand the purpose of a research paper introduction
- Identify the key components of an effective introduction
- Avoid common mistakes in writing introductions
- Formulate a clear and concise thesis statement

TABLE OF CONTENTS

- Introduction
- What introduction should do
- Key components of an effective introduction
- How to start an introduction
- Common mistakes to avoid
- Activity
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RESEARCH

- Research is a systemic investigation into and study of materials and sources in order to establish facts and rearch new conclusions.

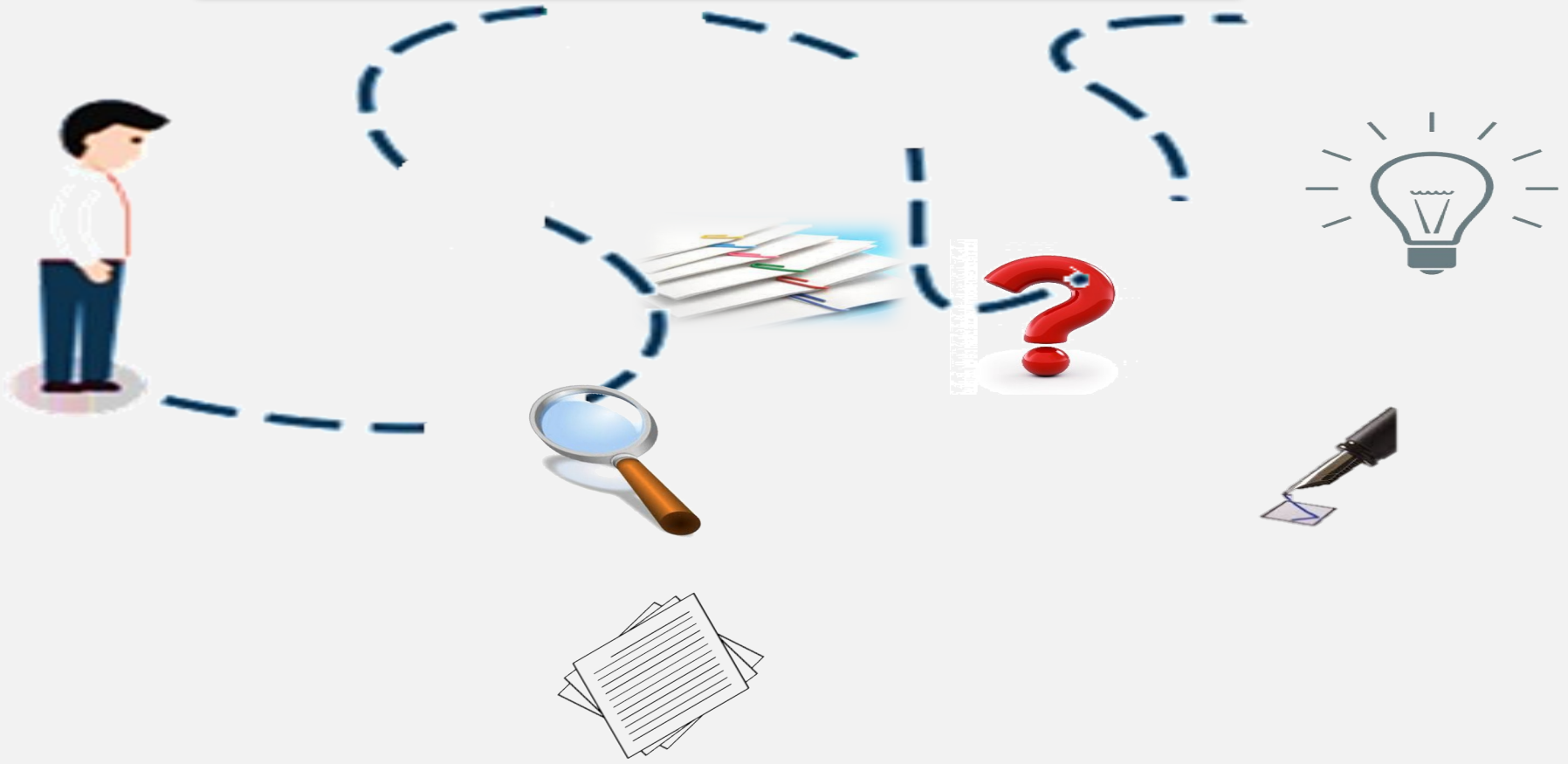
Different parts of a research paper

- ✓ Title
- ✓ Abstract
- ✓ Keywords
- ✓ Introduction



- ✓ Material & Methods
- ✓ Results & Discussion
- ✓ Conclusion
- ✓ Acknowledgments
- ✓ References

“Introduction ”



INTRODUCTION

- This presentation focuses on the essential role of the introduction in a research paper.
- The introduction helps to set the context, engage the reader, and clearly present the main argument or thesis of your paper.
- Writing a strong introduction is crucial for making your research compelling.

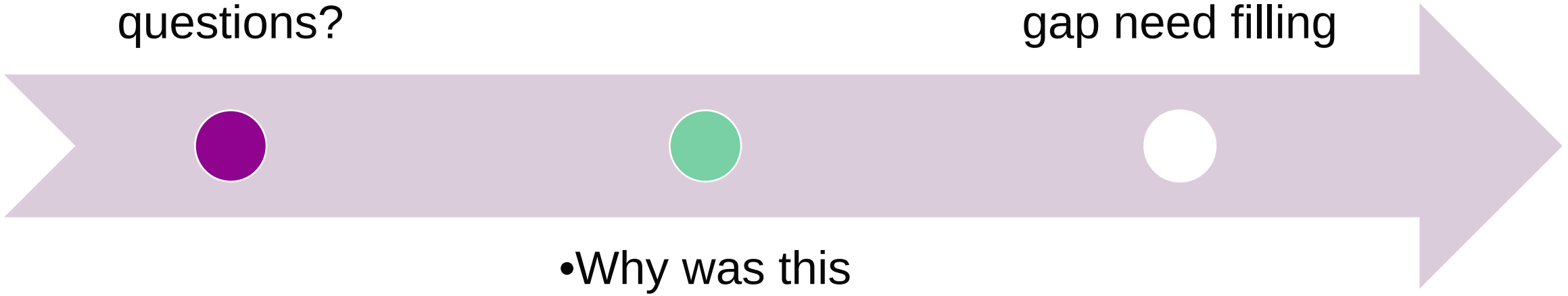
WHAT IS AN INTRODUCTION ?

- Introduction is precisely an outline of your research
- The first content slide of your research presentation
- Sets the context for your topic
- Grabs attention and informs the audience about the research purpose

What the Introduction Should Do

- Introduce/orient towards topic
- Explain importance and relevance of topic
- Justify choice of topic
- Present the problem
- What is already known about the topic (lit review)
- Share your **focus or objective**

Answer two main questions?



•Why was this study needed to fill the gap in scientific knowledge

•Why does this gap need filling

Key Elements of an Introduction Slide

- Background or Context
- Problem Statement or Research Gap
- Research Objectives or Questions
- Significance of the Study

❖ Background / Context

- ❖ Introduce the general topic area
- ❖ Explain why the topic is important
- ❖ Include brief statistics or facts if helpful

📝 ***Example:***

“Oral diseases affect 3.5 billion people globally, with dental caries being the most common among children.”

❖ Problem Statement / Gap

- ❖ Define the specific issue your research addresses
- ❖ Highlight what's missing in current knowledge or practice

📝 ***Example:***

“Despite preventive efforts, dental caries remains highly prevalent among school-aged children, indicating a need for more effective interventions.”

❖ Research Objective / Question

❖ What is your research trying to find out or prove?

📝 ***Example:***

“To evaluate the effectiveness of fluoride varnish in reducing caries in children aged 6–12 over a 6-month period.”

❖ Significance of the Study

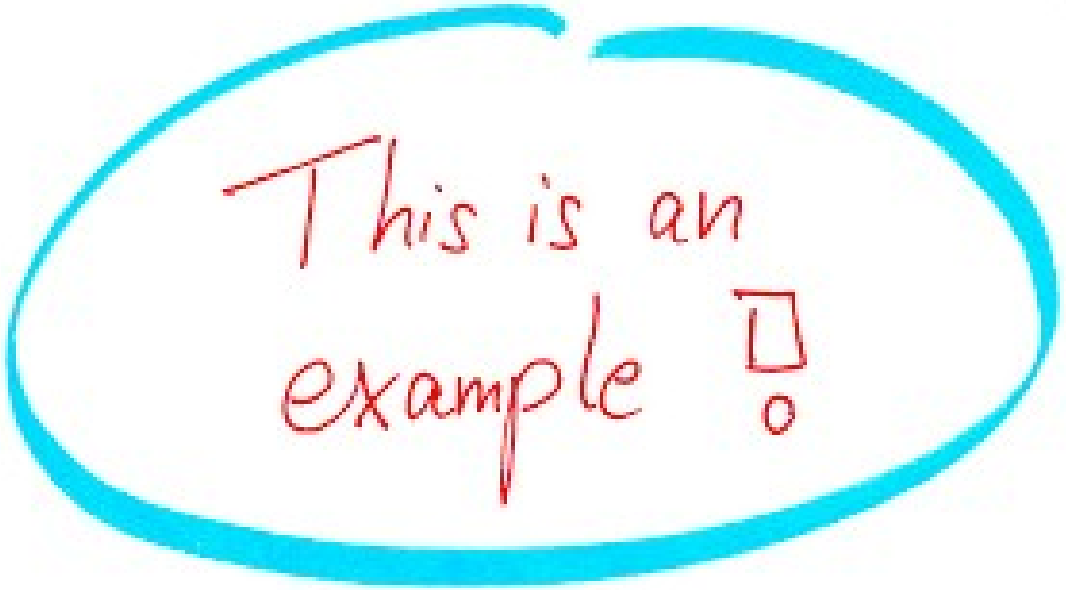
❖ Who will benefit from your research?

❖ Why does it matter in the real world or academic field?

📝 ***Example:***

“This study may influence preventive dental care strategies in pediatric dentistry and guide national oral health policies.”

Let's review the tips about Introduction



EXAMPLE

- **Background**
- Dental caries is one of the most common chronic diseases in children worldwide.
- Preventive dentistry plays a crucial role in reducing early childhood caries.
- **Problem Statement**
- Despite regular brushing, many children still develop caries due to inadequate preventive care.
- The long-term effectiveness of fluoride varnish is still debated in some regions.

Research Objective

To evaluate the effectiveness of fluoride varnish in preventing dental caries among children aged 6–12.

Significance

The study may support evidence-based preventive strategies in pediatric dental care.

Results can guide public health programs and clinical protocols.

EXAMPLE

- **Background**
- Edentulism is loss of all teeth and is end stage of burden of oral disease
- This chronic dental state leads to compromised masticatory efficiency.
- Edentulism negatively affects oral health related quality of life (OHRQoL), leading to functional, psychological and social impairment that disrupts day to day life

- **Problem Statement**
- Due to the non-life-threatening nature of tooth loss, it is often disregarded and ignored leading to inclination towards symptomatic treatment only

- **Research Objective**
- the objective of this study was to investigate the frequency of edentulism and its associated factors among patients attending a tertiary care hospital in Karachi.

- **Significance**
- Even though studies have been conducted in global settings, there is lack of epidemiological data in the field of Prosthodontics in our part of the world. Multiple factors can interplay and lead to edentulism in geriatric patients. This study will help in identifying these factors in our local setting. Keeping these factors in mind, patients can be educated so as to decrease the burden of disease i.e. early tooth loss in our population.

General Dos and Don'ts

"Introduction"







Do's



- Download samples of research paper introductions.
- Questions and objectives should locate in the last Paragraph.
- Use recent and new references for the literature review.
- Follow guidelines of professional writing.

Don’t



- Too long introduction will reduce the interest of reader.
- Do not put the final results and analyzing the result section, etc.
- Do not use old-references.
- Do not write slang phrases (really, cool, etc.)
- Never copy a sentence from a study/paper/book (Plagiarize)
- Avoid contractions, let’s, won’t, can’t, don’t, etc.

Conclusion

- The introduction plays a key role in guiding the reader into your research paper. It should provide a clear overview of the topic, offer relevant background and present a focused thesis.
- By applying the strategies discussed today, you can write introductions that are clear, engaging, and academically strong.

Activity: Write an Introduction Paragraph

- **Topic:** ***The Importance of Regular Dental Check-Ups***
- **Your Task:**
  Write a short **introduction paragraph** (4–6 sentences) that includes:
  - An **engaging opening sentence** to draw interest
  - **Background information** to introduce the topic
  - A **clear and focused thesis statement** that presents your main argument
- 🕑 **Time:** 8–10 minutes
  📣 **Share:** Volunteers will have the opportunity to read their introductions aloud for constructive feedback.
- 💡 *Tip:*
  You can begin with a surprising statistic, a question, or a common misunderstanding related to dental visits

Thank you